



Lab: Assess your Communication Style

Estimated duration: 15 minutes

Objectives

In this hands-on lab, you will:

- Identify your preferred communication style

Prerequisites

1. Ensure you have viewed all module videos before this hands-on lab.
2. You must have Microsoft Excel installed on your computer or a Microsoft Office 365 account online. If you want to sign up for Microsoft Office 365 online and need help with the steps, view the [Sign-up for Microsoft 365 lab](#).
3. If you are new to Microsoft Excel, view the [Fundamentals of Excel Online lab](#).

Exercise 1: Identify your Preferred Communication Style

Step 1: Keeping the CTRL key pressed, click [here](#) to download the **Communication Style Survey**.

Note: On Mac systems, keep the Command (CMD) key pressed instead of the CTRL key.

Step 2: There are five worksheets on the Communications Style Survey spreadsheet. The first four worksheets are:

- Analytical
- Structural
- Conceptual
- Social

Each worksheet contains statements about the four communication styles, as shown in the image below.

Statement	5	4	3	2	1
Accuracy of the work is critical.					
Simply communicate the bottom line to me.					
I prefer an executive summary presentation.					
I need information ahead of time to analyze.					
When it comes to communications, less is more.					
I prefer logical, data-based communications.					
I need reasonable time to digest information.					
Give me an opportunity for questions.					
Total Score	0				

>	Analytical	Structural	Conceptual	Social	Results	+	:	◀
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Step 3: Begin with the statements in the **Analytical** worksheet. Read each statement and rate yourself on a scale of 1 to 5, with 1 being Strongly Disagree and 5 being Strongly Agree. Place an **X** in the box that best represents your score. Complete all boxes on the worksheet.

Step 4: Select the **Structural** worksheet. Rate yourself for each statement by placing an **X** in the box that best represents your score. Complete all boxes on the worksheet.

Step 5: Select the **Conceptual** worksheet. Rate yourself for each statement by placing an **X** in the box that best represents your score. Complete all boxes on the worksheet.

Step 6: Select the **Social** worksheet. Rate yourself for each statement by placing an **X** in the box that best represents your score. Complete all boxes on the worksheet.

Step 7: Select the **Results** worksheet after rating yourself for each communication style.

- Your score for each communication style and highest preferred style are displayed on the Results worksheet, as shown in the image below.
- If two scores are the same, consider both to be your highest preferred style. However, the style associated with the first top score is the highest preferred style in the document.
- Normally, a score that is 25 or higher indicates a preference. Analytical and Conceptual are preferences in the example shown.

Communication style	Scores	
Analytical	29.03	
Structural	15.05	
Conceptual	37.63	
Social	18.28	
Dominant Style	37.63	Conceptual

Step 8: The table summarizes some tips on effectively communicating with individuals with different communication styles. Review each communication style tip.

Communication Style	Tips for Effective Communication
Analytical	• Keep your communications short—get to the point quickly. • Beware of hijacking—state your what, why, and who criteria up-front. • Avoid drama, emotion, and surprises—focus on solving the problem. • Strive for communications that are accurate, brief, and concise. • Key on value. Show the return on investment. • Expect some impatience and judgmental language—do not be intimidated. • Do not try to bluff your way through if you do not know. • Have supporting information in your back pocket—ensure you have the facts.
Structural	• Have an agenda—be organized—stay within the rules and guidelines. • Provide read-ahead copies before presentation. • Have details available if needed. • Key on predictability and results. • Avoid out-of-the-box what-if scenarios. • Key on how, when, and where questions—show who will be in control. • Consider a step-by-step process-oriented approach – show how to get it done. • Minimize changes and surprises whenever possible.
Conceptual	• Allow time for brainstorming and open-ended questions. • Be ready to discuss the possibilities—what could be. • Show the big picture—use visual depictions to your advantage. • Metaphors work—expect abstract thinking—be prepared. • Don't jump into the details unless necessary.

	• Have all options available to discuss. • Try to manage the tangents—the conversation will shift quickly. • Show numbers and facts graphically.
Social	• Show how an idea will affect others. • Share who is driving the idea and who is on the team. • Ensure you make eye contact and watch your non-verbal cues. • Personalize information as much as possible. • Give opportunity for others to ask questions and respond—avoid interrupting. • The use of stories and parables can be effective. • Introduce yourself and your team—try to establish a relationship when possible. • Show passion and feeling for the conversation.

Be sure to attempt this exercise, as it will help you gain a clear understanding of the concepts covered in this module.